

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Centre Number	Candidate Number

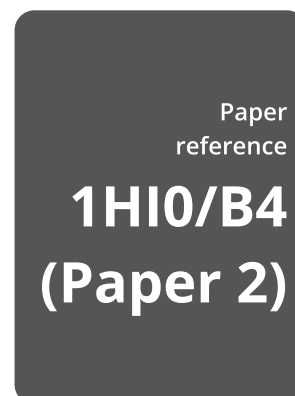
Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

Thursday 4 June 2026

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes -
total time for **both** booklets)

History

**BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England,
1558-88**



You must have:

The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided
- *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
- use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

©2026 Pearson Education Ltd.

Turn over ► Pearson

Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

- 1** (a) Describe one feature of Elizabethan grammar schools. (2)

- (b) Describe one feature of Elizabethan pastimes for the rich. (2)

(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

- 2 Explain why the Babington Plot (1586) led to the execution of Mary, Queen of Scots. (12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- Walsingham's spies
- The Act for the Preservation of the Queen's Safety

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

Turn over ►

(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)
Turn over ►

Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

EITHER

- 3** "The religious settlement of 1559 successfully solved the problem of religion in England."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- Catholic recusancy
- Puritan opposition

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)

OR

- 4** "Elizabeth's government was completely dependent on the Privy Council."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- William Cecil
- Parliament

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

Page 8 of 13

[illegible]

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwritten notes or essays. It features approximately 28 horizontal ruling lines spaced evenly down the page. Each line is composed of two parts: a solid black line at the top and a dashed black line immediately below it, creating a guide for letter height and placement. The entire page is otherwise blank, with no margins, headers, footers, or other markings.

TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS

PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.

BLANK PAGE

DO NOT WRITE ON THIS PAGE